Formula step cards

Tuesday 24 November 2026 | P6 | 40 minutes

Today I can

I can use cell references in formulas and check that totals update.

1 Check the data

Open Task. Check the input cells against the data card.

2 Build row formulas

In D4, multiply B4 by C4. Use * and start with =. Repeat for rows 5 and 6 using their own row numbers.

3 Add the total

In D7, add D4 through D6 with =SUM(D4:D6).

4 Test a change

Predict first. Change B4 from 3 to 5. Check D4 and D7. Keep this change.

5 Save and check

Save your own workbook. Close it and reopen it. Show a formula and its result.

Private responses

Point, write, type or speak quietly to an adult. No reading aloud is required.

Words for spreadsheets

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cell

One box in a spreadsheet.

cell reference

The column letter and row number, such as B4.

input

A value you enter or change.

formula

An instruction that starts with = and works out a result.

range

A group of cells, such as D4:D6.

recalculate

Work out the results again when an input changes.

A useful reason

My formula uses ... so the result changes when ...

_____

_____

Knowledge organiser

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The aim

I can use cell references in formulas and check that totals update.

Cell references

B4 means column B, row 4. References link the formula to the input cells.

Formula signs

= starts a formula. * multiplies. SUM adds a range. D4:D6 means D4, D5 and D6.

Check carefully

Check the formula as well as the displayed answer. A typed result does not update. Check any blank input before trusting the total.

My success checks

[ ] I used cell references in my formulas.
[ ] I checked the row results and whole total.
[ ] I changed an input and checked the new total.
[ ] I saved and reopened my own workbook.

Where this leads

Office and stock roles use spreadsheets to check quantities. Explaining a formula gives evidence of a digital skill for an application.

Practice data card

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The task

How many points does this activity kit need? These are made-up practice points, not money.

Use the Task sheet

The grid below matches the cell addresses. Row 3 holds headings. Rows 4 to 6 hold data. D4:D7 are left blank for your formulas.

Row	A	B	C	D
3	**Item**	**Quantity**	**Points each**	**Total points**
4	Paper packs	3	4	
5	Card packs	2	5	
6	Fastener packs	4	2	
7	Total points			

Calculate

D4 = quantity x points each for row 4. Do the same for rows 5 and 6. D7 adds the three row totals.

Change test

Write a prediction. Change B4 from 3 to 5. Check D4 and D7. Keep B4 at 5 when you save.

Keep the right sheet

Use Task for your work. Model has different data and is for the adult example. Do not copy its answers.

Supported route

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The aim

I can use cell references in formulas and check that totals update.

Steps

1. Open the Task sheet and check the six inputs.
2. In D4, type =B4*C4. Press Enter.
3. Use row 5 references in D5, then row 6 in D6.
4. In D7, type =SUM(D4:D6). Check the total.
5. Predict, then change B4 from 3 to 5. Check D4 and D7.
6. Save, close and reopen your own file.

My check

Before: D4 = ... and D7 = ...
After B4 changes to 5: D4 = ... and D7 = ...
The result changes because ...

Success

[ ] I used cell references in my formulas.
[ ] I checked the row results and whole total.
[ ] I changed an input and checked the new total.
[ ] I saved and reopened my own workbook.

Private responses

Use your book or a private device. You may point or ask for exact scribing.

Independent route

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The aim

I can use cell references in formulas and check that totals update.

Steps

1. Check the Task sheet against the data card.
2. Use cell references to multiply quantity by points each.
3. Complete D4, D5 and D6 with row formulas.
4. Add a formula in D7 for the total of D4:D6.
5. Predict and test B4 changing from 3 to 5. Explain the change.
6. Save, close and reopen your own file.

My check

Before: D4 = ... and D7 = ...
After B4 changes to 5: D4 = ... and D7 = ...
The result changes because ...

Success

[ ] I used cell references in my formulas.
[ ] I checked the row results and whole total.
[ ] I changed an input and checked the new total.
[ ] I saved and reopened my own workbook.

Private responses

Use your book or a private device. You may point or ask for exact scribing.

Aspire route

Tuesday 24 November 2026 | P6 | 40 minutes

The aim

I can use cell references in formulas and check that totals update.

Steps

1. Complete the Independent task first.
2. Predict D6 and D7 if B6 changes from 4 to 0. Test it.
3. Explain why 0 and an empty cell can mean different things.
4. Check that each row formula uses its own row.
5. Restore B6 to 4 and keep B4 at 5. Check the total.
6. Save a new v2 copy and keep v1.

My check

Before: D4 = ... and D7 = ...
After B4 changes to 5: D4 = ... and D7 = ...
The result changes because ...

Success

[ ] I used cell references in my formulas.
[ ] I checked the row results and whole total.
[ ] I changed an input and checked the new total.
[ ] I saved and reopened my own workbook.

Private responses

Use your book or a private device. You may point or ask for exact scribing.

My evidence record

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My file and folder

_____

One row formula and the total formula

_____

Before the change

D4 = _____ D7 = _____

After B4 changes from 3 to 5

D4 = _____ D7 = _____

Why the results changed

_____

Saved workbook reopened

Yes / Not yet

My response to the next step

_____

Adult record

Date: _____ Support used: _____
Seen / supported / not yet: references; totals; change; reopen.
Next step: _____
Response acknowledged: _____